Private Wealth / RIA Pre-Sales Scoping Rubric & Effort Multiplier

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Use this rubric on every deal where investors are onboarded through wealth advisors, registered investment advisers (RIAs), broker-dealers or feeder platforms rather than directly. Our institutional scoping template asks how many investors a fund has. It never asks who fills in the forms. In CASE-2026-003 that gap cost four weeks of delivery.

Section 1. Discovery Questions (ask before quoting)

(a) Who prepares subscriptions: the investor, the advisor, an advisor's assistant, or a home-office operations team?

(b) How many advisors, at how many firms, and how many client accounts per advisor (median and maximum)?

(c) Which account types are in scope: individual, joint (JTWROS or tenants in common), IRA or other custodial account, revocable or irrevocable trust, entity?

(d) Does the advisor attest to suitability or provide a certification, and is a home-office supervisory review required?

(e) Will advisors upload client lists in bulk, and in what format? Is there a CRM or custodian feed?

(f) Can advisors move between firms during the offering, and how are client relationships re-assigned?

(g) What is the closing cadence (monthly, quarterly, continuous)?

Section 2. Effort Multiplier

Start from the institutional baseline estimate (B) for the same fund documents. Multiply by every factor that applies.

Factor	Condition	Multiplier
Delegated preparation	Advisors prepare subscriptions for clients (1-to-many)	× 1.35
Book size	Median of more than 25 accounts per advisor	× 1.10
Bulk intake	Advisors upload client lists (CSV or feed)	× 1.15
Custodial accounts	IRAs or other custodial accounts in scope	× 1.15
Joint and trust accounts	More than one signer type per account	× 1.05
Supervisory review	Home-office or broker-dealer review step	× 1.10
Advisor mobility	Advisors may change firms mid-offering	× 1.05
Continuous closes	Monthly or continuous closing cadence	× 1.05

Note: In CASE-2026-003 the institutional baseline was 6 weeks. With delegated preparation, book size, bulk intake, custodial accounts, joint/trust accounts and advisor mobility, the rubric gives 6 × 2.17 ≈ 13

weeks; actual delivery took 10 weeks across two phases, against the 6 originally quoted.

Section 3. Access Model Defaults

Start from `advisor_delegated_access_matrix.csv`. The non-negotiables are:

- An advisor sees only clients linked to their current, active rep code; access is re-evaluated nightly and on every transfer event.
- Assistants act for an advisor but never attest suitability.
- Advisors prepare and send; investors review and sign. No advisor signs on a client's behalf.
- The home office sees its whole firm but cannot change an investor's reviewed answers.
- For IRAs, the custodian signs its acceptance after the investor.

Section 4. Phasing Pattern

When the client's first close is fixed, offer two phases instead of a slipped single launch:

Phase	Scope	Typical timing
1	Advisor delegation, single-account preparation, individual and joint accounts	Baseline B, for the first close
2	Bulk intake, custodial (IRA) routing, home-office dashboards	B + 4 weeks

Section 5. Red Flags That Need a Solutions Architect Before Quoting

- More than 5,000 investors or more than 100 advisors.
- A broker-dealer supervisory workflow with its own approval system.
- A feeder platform sitting between the advisor and us.
- Advisors who expect to sign on clients' behalf under powers of attorney.

Section 6. Worked Example: Brookhaven Private Wealth (CASE-2026-003)

Input	Value
Investors	About 2,500 HNW investors
Advisors	About 60 advisors at 9 RIA firms; median 42 accounts each
Account types	Individual, JTWROS, IRA, revocable trust
Quoted (institutional template)	6 weeks
Rubric estimate	About 13 weeks (6 × 2.17)
Delivered	Phase 1 in 6 weeks (23 Feb 2026), phase 2 four weeks later (23 Mar 2026)